

Room Name: Snapped Phish-ing Line

Date: August 2026

Category: Phishing

Tools Used: VirusTotal, CyberChef

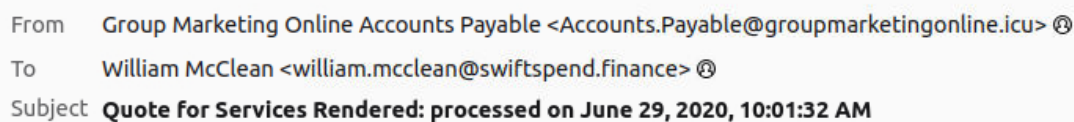
Scenario

Multiple employees have received suspicious emails. We are tasked with finding evidence of compromise and find as much information as we can on the emails so we can confirm the suspicions on the emails.

The emails are ready, sitting in the phish-emails folder of the Virtual Machine (VM). One thing to note is that this writeup will only focus on the questions asked in the rooms

Investigation

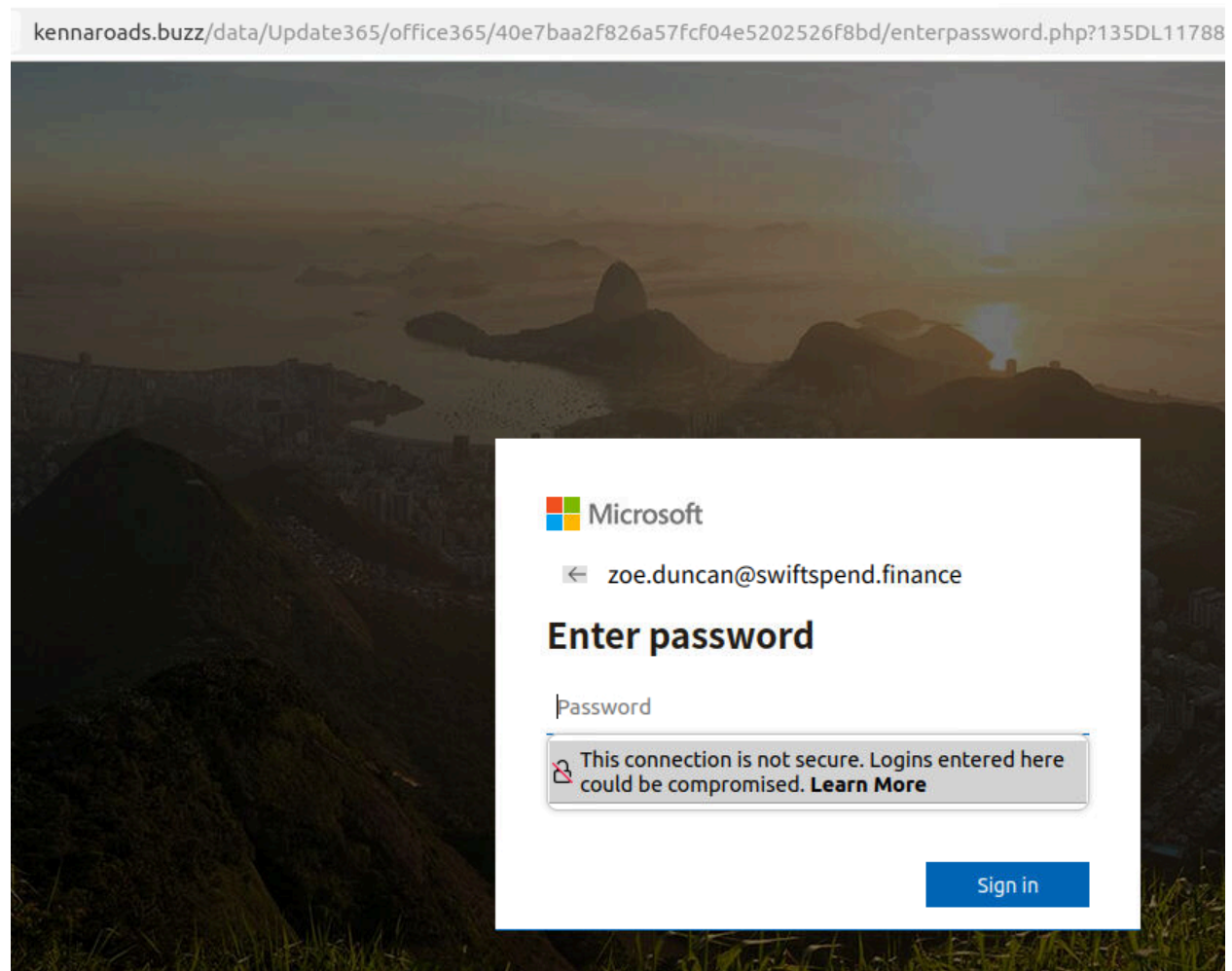
For the following email all the room requires is the email address of the adversary and the name of the recipient of the email. When opening the Quote for Services Rendered email, I could immediately see from the email's headers that William McClean received the email from the adversary's email, Accounts[.]Payable@groupmarketingonline[.]icu.



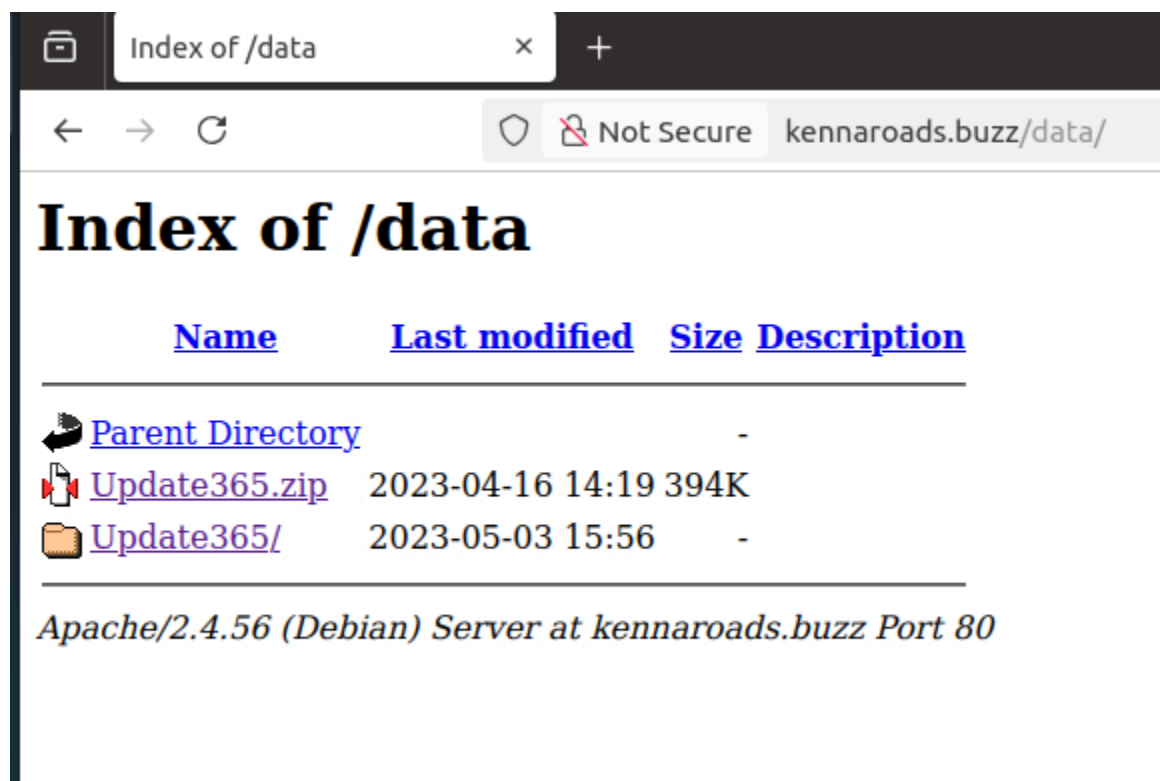
From Group Marketing Online Accounts Payable <Accounts.Payable@groupmarketingonline.icu> @
To William McClean <william.mcclean@swiftspend.finance> @
Subject **Quote for Services Rendered: processed on June 29, 2020, 10:01:32 AM**

Opening the email Zoe Duncan received, one thing that caught my attention was that the same scheme was used from Accounts[.]Payable@groupmarketingonline[.]icu. Indicating that most of these emails seemed to be sent by the same adversary. This email had an html attachment. After downloading the html

file and opening it in the VM, a page impersonating microsoft was opened. I also noticed the root domain behind this was a domain called kennaroad[.]buzz.



After doing a website redirection to the /data directory (hxxp[:]kennaroads[.]buzz/data/) I found an archived zip folder left exposed by the attacker.



This prompted me to download that zip folder and get its hash to determine if the folder contained malware. To get the hash I used the SHA256sum command.

```
Index of /data
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17: ~/Downloads
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17:~$ cd Downloads
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17:~/Downloads$ ls
Update365  'Update365(1).zip'  Update365.zip
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17:~/Downloads$ sha256sum Update365.zip
ba3c15267393419eb08c7b2652b8b6b39b406ef300ae8a18fee4d16b19ac9686  Update365.zip
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17:~/Downloads$
```

After getting the hash, I opened VirusTotal and used the hash to analyze the archived folder. VirusTotal revealed not only phishing attempts but also Trojans. VirusTotal also identified hacking tools possibly indicating tool that the attacker might have used.

32
/ 64
Community
Score

-3

32/64 security vendors flagged this file as malicious

ba3c15267393419eb08c7b2652b8b6b39b406ef300ae8a18fee4d16b19ac9686

Update365.zip

zip checks-user-input long-sleeps detect-debug-environment

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

BEHAVIOR

COMMUNITY 6

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Popular threat label

trojan.phishmailer/phishingms

Threat categories

trojan phishing hacktool

Security vendors' analysis

Alibaba Trojan:HTML/Phishing.62b2fe1f AliCloud

When looking at the details of VirtusTotal's scan, I also found that there were a total of 49 files contained in the archived folder.

Contents Metadata	
Contained Files	49

After doing another website redirection to the /data/Update365/ directory

(hxxp[://]kennaroads[.]buzz/data/Update365/), I found a log.txt file.

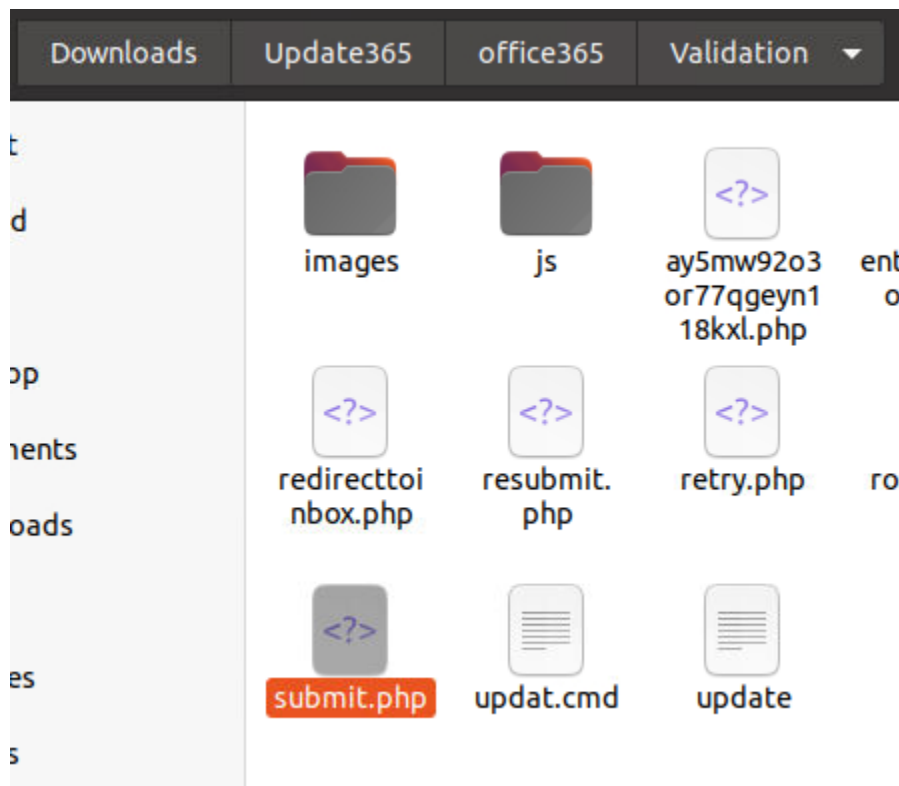
Index of /data/Update365			
← → ↻ Not Secure kennaroads.buzz/data/Update365/			
Index of /data/Update365			
Name	Last modified	Size	Description
 Parent Directory		-	
 log.txt	2023-05-03 15:56	2.5K	
 office365/	2020-01-13 10:01	-	
Apache/2.4.56 (Debian) Server at kennaroads.buzz Port 80			

When oping the log.txt file, I found that the email michael[.]ascot@swiftspend[.]finance had multiple login attempts possibly indicating a brute-force attack by the attacker, trying to login to Michael's

account.

```
-----
Client IP: 158.62.17.197
User Agent : Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Ubuntu; Linux x86_64; rv:109.0) Gecko/20100101 Firefox/112.0
Country : Philippines
Date: Mon Jun 29, 2020 10:00 am
--- http://www.geoptool.com/?IP=158.62.17.197 ----
--> Created BY Real Carder +---
-----+ Office365 Login |+-----
Email : michael.ascot@swiftspend.finance
Password : Invoice2023!
-----
Client IP: 64.62.197.80
User Agent : Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/60.0.3112.113 Safari/537.36
Country : United States
Date: Mon Jun 29, 2020 10:01 am
--- http://www.geoptool.com/?IP=64.62.197.80 ----
--> Created BY Real Carder +---
-----+ Office365 Login |+-----
Email : zoe.duncan@swiftspend.finance
Password : Passw0rd1!
-----
Client IP: 64.62.197.80
User Agent : Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/60.0.3112.113 Safari/537.36
Country : United States
Date: Mon Jun 29, 2020 10:01 am
--- http://www.geoptool.com/?IP=64.62.197.80 ----
--> Created BY Real Carder +---
-----+ Office365 Login |+-----
Email : michael.ascot@swiftspend.finance
Password : Invoice2023!
-----
```

I then chose to extract the archived zip folder and found a submit.php file.



After running the cat command via terminal to read the submit.php file,

```

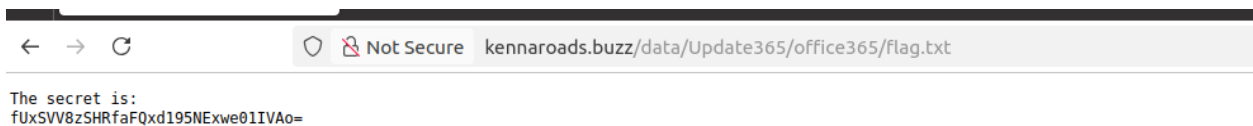
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17:~/Downloads/Update365$ ls
office365
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17:~/Downloads/Update365$ cd office365
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17:~/Downloads/Update365/office365$ ls
blocker.php  error_log  robots.txt  script.st  updat.cmd  Validation
delete.php   index.php  scr          Scriptup   update
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17:~/Downloads/Update365/office365$ cd Validation
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17:~/Downloads/Update365/office365/Validation$ ls
ay5mw92o3or77qgeyn118kxl.php  loader.gif          security-assurance.php
enterpasswordagain.php         redirecttoinbox.php style.css
enterpassword.php              resubmit.php        submit.php
images                         retry.php           updat.cmd
index.php                     robots.txt          update
js                             script.st
damianhall@ip-10-145-154-17:~/Downloads/Update365/office365/Validation$ cat subm
it.php

```

I discovered that the adversary was actually using the email m3npat@yandex[.]com to collect compromised credentials.

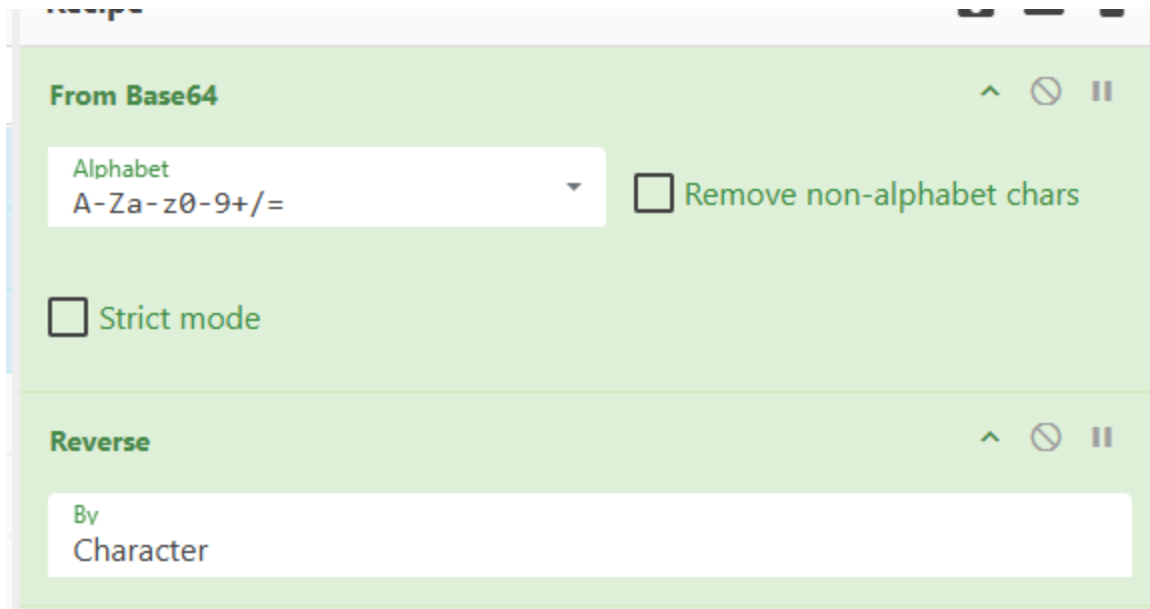
```
$send = "m3npat@yandex.com";
```

I decided to do one more redirection and try and see if the flag was hidden like the archived file by redirecting to data/Update365/office365/flag.txt, where i discovered a base64 string of characters.



The secret is:
fUxSVV8zSHRfaFQxd195NExwe01IVAo=

I opened up CyberChef and pasted that base64 string but got the flag reversed, so I also added reverse to the recipe and then the flag got revealed properly.



Classification:

As identified by VirusTotal, the emails were sent by a user with a folder with many flagged vendors and Trojans, indicating this scenario as a True Positive for phishing.

Key Takeaways:

- There can be hidden files within a website accidentally left by the attacker. With the knowledge of commonly known directory names a simple redirection can expose valuable files or folders.
- The attacker left their entire phishing kit exposed on the server
- Credentials were being harvested to m3npat@yandex[.]com — a common attacker collection method using free email services
- The .icu and .buzz TLDs are heavily abused for phishing — treat them as high suspicion by default